

Lesson: Present Simple – The Verb BE

Today, we are going to learn about one of the most important verbs in English: the verb **BE**. This verb is unique because it doesn't behave like other action verbs. Instead of showing an action, it **describes a state of being**, identity, or condition. We use it in the **present simple tense** to talk about facts, personal information, feelings, and occupations. Understanding how to use **BE** correctly will help you make clear and correct sentences in English.

The verb **BE** changes form depending on the subject of the sentence. For **positive sentences**, we use:

- *I am* (I'm)
- *You/we/they are* (you're/we're/they're)
- *He/she/it is* (he's/she's/it's)

For example, you can say: *I'm from Japan.* or *She's from India.* These sentences tell us about who someone is or where they come from. Notice that we also have **contractions** like *I'm* instead of *I am* and *he's* instead of *he is*, which are very common in spoken English.

When we want to **make negative sentences**, we add **not** after the verb BE. The forms are:

- *I am not* (I'm not)
- *You/we/they are not* (you're not/we're not/they're not)
- *He/she/it is not* (he isn't/she isn't/it isn't)

For instance, you can say: *I'm not married.* or *She isn't a student.* This tells us that something is **not true** about the subject. Using the correct negative form is important because it completely changes the meaning of the sentence.

To **ask questions** with the verb BE, we invert the subject and the verb. The question forms are:

- *Am I...?*
- *Are you/we/they...?*
- *Is he/she/it...?*

For example, you can ask: *Am I beautiful?* or *Is he tall?* Asking questions this way is straightforward, but it requires attention to the correct subject-verb form. Remember, the verb always comes **before the subject** in questions.

We often use the verb **BE** in everyday situations, and it's helpful to know the most common ones. One situation is **names**. You can introduce yourself or others using BE: *I'm Joanna.* or *They're Aki and Yuta.* This is the easiest way to start a conversation or provide basic personal information.

Another common use is for **country or nationality**. You can describe where someone is from or their nationality: *I'm from the U.S. I'm American.* or *She's not Korean; she's Vietnamese.* You can also ask questions like: *Are they from Australia?* This helps when meeting new people or talking about others.

We also use BE to talk about **age**. For example: *I'm 27 years old.* or *She's 15.* You can ask: *How old are you?* Talking about age is a basic but very common use of the verb BE in everyday conversations.

Another important use is for **emotions or feelings**. BE helps us describe how we feel: *I'm sad.* *She's excited.* *You're angry.* *We're happy.* This is especially useful when talking about ourselves or understanding how others feel.

Finally, we use BE to talk about **jobs or professions**. For example: *I'm not a student; I'm a teacher.* or *He's a journalist.* We can also ask: *Are you a doctor?* This form is practical when introducing yourself or asking about someone's occupation.

In conclusion, the verb **BE** is a versatile and essential part of English. It is used to describe **identity, nationality, age, feelings, and jobs**, and it changes form depending on the subject. Remember the positive, negative, and question forms, and practice using contractions in daily conversation. Mastering this verb will allow you to confidently describe yourself and others, ask questions, and share important information about people and things around you.